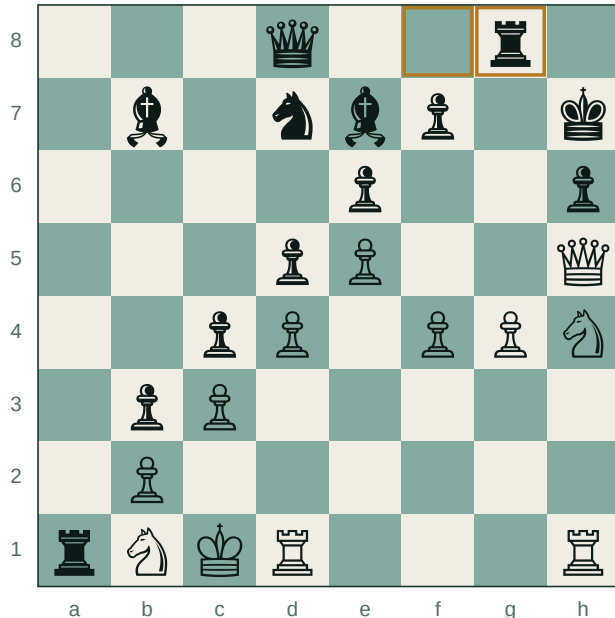


Hook mating nets: White, move 26

Hook mating nets

White to move



Previous move: 25...Rg8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26. Qxh6+ Kxh6 27. Nf5+ Kg6 28. Rh6#

26.Qxh6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on h6. Recorded reply: **26...Kxh6**.

27.Nf5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From f5 it attacks king on h6 and bishop on e7. Recorded reply: **27...Kg6**.

28.Rh6# Mate: rook on h6 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g6. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h6. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Recount the king's legal replies after each move. A changed pawn placement can destroy an otherwise familiar mating pattern.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A hook-type mating net combines rook pressure with knight control and supporting pawn geometry. The supporting pieces can matter more than the apparent value of a sacrifice.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the final checking line and then trace which friendly pieces protect the attacker and control the king's exits.

The defending king is on h7. Absolute pin: pawn on h6.